

Infection Control Policy

VERSION 1.0	EFFECTIVE	NEXT REVIEW	OWNER Principal / Key Management Personnel	APPROVED BY Governing body
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PURPOSE AT A GLANCE

This policy explains how [] prevents the transmission of infectious agents and manages infections if they occur — through standard precautions in every setting, worker training in hand and respiratory hygiene and the use of PPE, routine environmental cleaning, and an infection-control risk management plan.

1. Purpose and scope

This policy supports [] to apply the Risk Management and Safe Environment NDIS Practice Standards. It applies to all services and supports delivered by [] and to all employees, contractors and volunteers (**Workers**), who must take full responsibility for understanding and following it. It should be read alongside the related documents in the final section and the corresponding procedures in the Policy Register.

2. Policy aims

[] is committed to ensuring that:

- risks of infection to participants, workers and [] are regularly assessed, identified and managed;
- infection prevention and control standard precautions are implemented in all settings in which supports are provided, and each worker is trained (with refresher training) in standard precautions — hand hygiene, respiratory hygiene and cough etiquette — and in the use of PPE; and
- PPE is available to each worker and participant who requires it, and records of infection-control activities, training and information provided to participants are maintained.

3. Standard precautions

Effective infection control is integral to participant support, not an additional set of practices. The main modes of transmission are contact (including blood-borne), droplet and airborne; transmission can also occur through contaminated food, water, medications, devices and equipment. Standard precautions — hand hygiene at the recommended moments, respiratory hygiene and cough etiquette, safe handling and disposal of sharps, appropriate PPE, and safe handling of linen and waste — are applied in every setting. Routine environmental cleaning is conducted where supports are provided (other than in participants' homes), particularly of frequently touched surfaces.

4. Respecting participants

Participants' rights are respected at all times. They are involved in decisions about their support and are sufficiently informed to participate in reducing the risk of transmission. For each participant, protocols and

escalation systems are in place for responding to medical emergencies, and workers are trained to distinguish urgent from non-urgent health situations.

5. Infection-control risk management plan

Once infection risks are identified, []'s risk management program works through: eliminating the risk factors where possible; modifying procedures, protocols and work practices while monitoring compliance; providing PPE and training; and managing any infection or outbreak. Records of infection-control activities — training undertaken, information provided to participants, and PPE use — are maintained, and mechanisms are in place to monitor compliance. An occupational exposure (for example a needlestick injury) is managed with immediate first aid and risk assessment, same-day source assessment and documentation, post-exposure prophylaxis if indicated, and follow-up review.

6. Definitions

[]

[], ABN [].

Client

A client of [], including an NDIS participant.

Key Management Personnel (KMP)

[], and other key management personnel involved in [] from time to time.

Principal

[].

Legislation Register

The register of legislation, regulations, rules and guidelines maintained by [].

Policy Register

The register of policies of [].

Worker

A permanent, fixed-term or casual member of staff, a contractor or a volunteer engaged by [], including the Principal.

Infection

Requires three elements — a source of the infectious agent, a mode of transmission, and a susceptible host.

Standard precautions

Work practices that require everyone to assume that all blood and body substances are potential sources of infection, independent of perceived risk.

Contact transmission

Transmission of an infectious agent by hand or via contact with blood or body substances — directly (person to person) or indirectly (through a contaminated object or person).

7. Related documents and approval

Related documents: Work Health and Safety Policy · COVID-19 Pandemic Management Policy · Waste Management Policy · Risk Management Policy · Incident Management and Reporting Policy · Human

Legislation and rules: as set out in the Legislation Register. If any part of this policy is inconsistent with applicable law, it is taken to be amended only to the extent needed to comply.

Approved by	
Approval date	
Next scheduled review	
Version	1.0